

HORS D'OEUVRES **DILIP BOBB**

Emotional Infidelity



At the workplace, among groups of friends, at a gym or in cyberspace, there are invariably a male and a female, both married, who will connect in a non-sexual way. There may be a physical attraction but largely it's based on shared interests, values, personalities and, perhaps a bit of harmless flirting. However innocent, such relationships constitute a silent new threat in today's marriages. Sociologists call it 'Emotional Infidelity'. The relationship grows when the duo discover more about each other. Today's workplace is a prime breeding ground as more and more women join the corporate world, employees share longer hours and close friendships develop. The emotional bonding, over time, often becomes stronger than the one they have with their respective spouses. Pretty soon, they are exchanging intimate details about their personal lives, their marriage, their problems. It's an affair without the physical contact. The reason people have emotional affairs is they are looking for emotional nourishment they are not getting in their primary relationship. In emotional infidelity, personal intimacies are traded instead of sexual fantasies.

According to Shirley Glass, a psychologist, the first transgression of emotional infidelity is when two people share information about problems in their married life that their respective partners would treat as a violation. Suddenly, the emotional intimacy in the friendship is deeper than that of the primary relationship. Obviously, people in a troubled marriage are more vulnerable to emotional infidelity. However, most of those involved in emotional infidelity have no desire to leave their spouses. It's merely an attempt to reconcile conflicting needs. According to Professor Schwartz, author of relationship books, some people engage in emotional affairs for the "extra zing". These people have emotional affairs which are as deep-rooted as a physical affair, and, says Schwartz, "It might as well be sex." Gary Neuman, psychologist and author of *Emotional Infidelity*, argues that people need to learn to invest their emotional selves in their primary relationship, not in intense emotional bonds forged with colleagues and friends. He believes that if too much is spent outside the primary relationship, not enough is left to sustain it. "An emotional infidelity is about consistently sharing with someone (outside the relationship) things that you are not sharing with your spouse." That's a dangerous dependency. The dividing line between an emotional relationship and a physical one is pretty thin.



MARCH PAST: Jyoti Basu flags off the protest

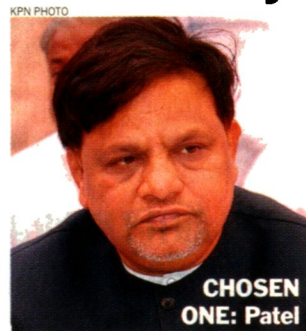
Coastal Turbulence

DELHI The Left parties converged in Visakhapatnam to protest Malabar 2007, a joint exercise of 21 warships from the US, Japan, Singapore, Australia and India in the Bay of Bengal earlier this week. In the fleet was the nuclear-powered *USS Nimitz*. Describing Malabar 2007 as "war games at sea", the CPI(M) distributed pamphlets which read, "Stop the Americanisation of the Indian defence services."

Foreign Minister Pranab Mukherjee worked out the modalities of the UPA-Left panel in the capital as allies such as RJD, NCP and DMK were still trying to read between the lines of the nuclear agreement. All this while Communist bosses Prakash Karat and A.B. Bardhan were busy leading the demonstrations along the coasts trying to further embarrass the Congress leadership.

by Satarupa Bhattacharjya

The Minority Reports



BANGALORE Less than a month before H.D. Kumaraswamy is scheduled to make way for BJP's B.S. Yediyurappa as chief minister under the power sharing arrangement, JD(S) honcho H.D. Deve Gowda has hinted that the agreement may not hold. At a routine party workers'

meeting, Gowda announced that he had chosen Muslim legislator Merajuddin Patel as the president of the state JD(S). The choice of 51-year-old Patel will no doubt act like a red rag to ally BJP. Both chief minister Kumaraswamy and his powerful brother H.D. Revanna were as much in the dark about Patel's announcement as the JD(S) rank and file cadre. Gowda is also believed to have indicated that Congress Union minister M.V. Rajashekar could be a possible chief ministerial candidate, in case the JD(S) and the Congress decide to patch up. by Stephen David